years of the Plan were adjusted by the Congress Government in a highly interesting way:

(a) The first year i.e 1978–79 was added to the fifth plan which was cut-short by the Janata Government to four years. And thus the Fifth Plan officially became of 5 years again (1974–79).

(b) Now what to do with the second year i.e. 1979–80. The Congress Government announced this year to be a year of one Annual Plan. This Annual Plan (1979–80) may be considered the lone independent remnant of the 'Rolling Plan' of the Janata Government.

The Sixth Plan (1978–83) which could not become an official plan of India had emphasis on some of the highly new economic ideas and ideals with almost a complete no to foreign investment; new thrust on the price control; rejuvenation of the Public Distribution System (PDS); emphasis on small scale and the cottage industries; new lease of life to the Panchayati Raj Institutions (i.e. the 2nd Phase of the frevival of the PRIs); agriculture and the subject of rural development getting the due; etc. being the major ones.

Sixth Plan

This Plan (1980–85) was launched with the slogan of '*Garibi Hatao*' (alleviate poverty).[72] Already, a programme (the TPP) was tested and tried by the same Government in the Fifth Plan which tried to improve the standard of living of the poor masses with the 'direct approach' (the idea of poverty alleviation but such a slogan of '*Garibi Hatao*' was not given to the programme).

Some of the major issues addressed by the Plan were—emphasis on socioeconomic infrastructure in the rural areas; eliminating rural poverty and reducing regional disparities through the IRDP (1979); 'target group'[73] approach initiated; a number of national level programmes and schemes were launched during the plan which tried to attend to the specific areas and the specific concerns of socioeconomic development (this is 'target group' approach):[74]

- National Rural Employment Programme (NREP)—1980